

THE WEIGHT OF NAMES

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OPENING IMAGE – CLOSE-UP – SPLIT LIP

INT. SCHOOL COUNSELOR'S OFFICE – LATE AFTERNOON

ON SCREEN TEXT:

“Sometimes the battles at home echo louder than the ones outside.”

NARRATOR (V.O.)

A tasteful office. Bookshelves stand tall. Dust caught in amber light.

Two boys fractured by silence—scars visible, others not.

Outside: the hum of wealth prowls in polished engines.

The first teenager sits taut, designer clothes betraying unrest.
A split lip gleams faintly, swollen cheek tender.

Across, the second teenager lounges—puffer jacket, swollen knuckles, a
smirk sharp as glass.

school counselor breathes slow, weary yet tender.

SECOND TEENAGER (cocky)

You gonna sit there and pretend you didn't start it?

FIRST TEENAGER (bare, wounded)

i didn't start anything. you know that

EXTENDED BREAKDOWN – FACES IN SHADOW

NARRATOR (V.O.)

One wears his bruise like a crown. The other wears his silence like shackles.
Between them—a counselor balancing hope against exhaustion.

SECOND TEENAGER (smug)

Your dad can't buy everything. Not even forgiveness.

FIRST TEENAGER (quiet, cracking)

He called me a coward.

The word lands heavy. Silence bruises deeper than fists.

SCHOOL COUNSELOR (gentle)

Names hurt. But hitting isn't the answer. Who are you trying to prove yourself to?

FIRST TEENAGER (breaking)

My mother. If I kept my head down, maybe she'd notice.

The second teenager grins—cruel, knowing.

SECOND TEENAGER (leaning in)

She'd patch the company logo before she'd patch you.

ON SCREEN TEXT:

"Approval is the rarest currency."

DOORWAY – PARENTS ARRIVE

The mother enters first immaculate, cold, a verdict in heels. The father follows, slightly out of step tailored suit, shoulders that once built, now burdened by distance.

MOTHER (flat)

This is... unfortunate.

Her son searches for approval. Finds none.

MOTHER (to First)

Do you understand how this looks? Your awards, your future now small print.

The boy crumples. father steps forward, guilt in his eyes.

FATHER (soft)

I worked so you could choose. Maybe i choose wrong. I'm sorry

FIRST TEENAGER (sharp)

You were never here.

The word never cuts deep. The father winces, guilt unmasked.

NARRATOR (V.O.)

Absence is a bruise no one sees.

THE RIVAL'S STING

SECOND TEENAGER (barbed, quiet)

Funny. My dad says they want to buy out what your father built.

The room stiffen corporate war bleeding into teenage skin.

MOTHER (icy)

My son's future is paramount.

SCHOOL COUNSELOR (rage, quiet)

Safety matters more than image.

The FATHER watches, torn, regret written in every line.

FATHER (low)

We can't let business dictate their lives.

NARRATOR (V.O.)

Wealth shields. But it also suffocates.

Loneliness is louder in polished halls.

second teenager rises, smirk lingering.

SECOND TEENAGER (to First)

Tell your dad he's got until Monday.

The door clicks. Silence blooms.

FINAL IMAGE – HONESTY

The father places a hand on his son's shoulder—not for show, but to stay.

FIRST TEENAGER (bare)

I'm tired of pretending money measures my worth.

I just wanted someone to tell me...that it was ok if i fail

The mother's lips part—no words come.

school counselor closes her file, steady.

SCHOOL COUNSELOR

Then let's start there. Honesty. And action.

NARRATOR (V.O.)

Privilege. Absence. Fear. These are the fractures.

But honesty, even whispered, can start repair.

ON SCREEN TEXT:

"Between fracture and repair lies choice."

FADE OUT.